Teacher Wu Kuan | Midterm Must-Miss #3 — −12 ÷ 4 × 3: Left to Right

English lecture notes · YouTube Short FEqSAWa8A14

1. The trap question

−12 ÷ 4 × 3 = −1 or −9?

2. The method

• × and ÷ have equal priority: go left to right.
• −12 ÷ 4 = −3, then × 3 = −9.
• Check: ÷ 4 = × 1/4 → (−12) × 1/4 × 3 = −9 in any order.

3. Parent check method

Have your child rewrite every ÷ as × (reciprocal) and confirm the answer doesn't change.

Practice

1. −20 ÷ 5 × 2
2. 18 ÷ (−3) × 2
3. −24 ÷ 6 ÷ 2
4. 8 × 3 ÷ (−4)
5. −12 ÷ (4 × 3) (note the parentheses)

Answers

1. −8
2. −12
3. −2
4. −6
5. −1

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